

Cold climate

Welcome to the mountains. Plants that live here have developed ways to cope with cold temperatures, snow, high winds, and strong sunlight. From warm coats to heated buds, these plants know how to protect themselves.

A snug coat

Many cold-climate plants have small leaves, because large leaves lose heat more quickly. Edelweiss leaves are also covered in hairs, which act like a warm coat in the open mountains.



A miniature ice breaker

Some plants try to beat the weather by flowering early. Alpine snowbells lying under snow heat the tips of their buds. This melts the snow so they can push through to the surface to flower.

